

Word-count declaration

Manuscript: *A Comparative Analysis of Relational Database Access-Layer Performance in Express.js for PostgreSQL and MySQL* (submission build `ist/ist_main.tex`).

Counted with `texcount` on the seven body sections plus the structured abstract, with each table and figure counted as 200 words per the IST author guidelines.

Component	Count
Body text (7 sections)	12,614
Structured abstract	295
Tables and figures in the main text (10×200)	2,000
Main-text total	14,909

This is under the journal’s 15,000-word limit. The reference list (70 entries) is provided separately. Twenty-six tables are placed in the numbered online supplement (`supplement.pdf`, Supplement Tables S1–S26), which is submitted with the manuscript and archived under the same Zenodo DOI as the code and data. In this revision (round 4) the manuscript was repositioned as a reproducible benchmark and a configuration-specific comparison; the body was cut to remove repeated conclusions; every per-pattern throughput table gained a 95% bootstrap confidence interval; controlled/uncontrolled-factor and per-layer-rank tables were added; and six new single-host experiments (utilization-controlled open-loop, multi-worker cluster, per-layer pool frontier on both engines, mixed read/write, replicated fan-out, and a longer-run sensitivity) were added as Supplement Tables S21–S26 with a one-sentence pointer each in the body.

Highlights (5 bullets, each ≤ 85 characters) are in `highlights.tex`.